



FIRST INFORMATION REPORT

(Under Section 173 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023)

FIR No.	FIR-2026-0002
Crime Registration No.	0087/2026
Police Station	CEN Cyber Crime Police Station
District	Bengaluru City
Date of Registration	19 July 2026
Time of Registration	11:20 hrs

1. CLASSIFICATION OF OFFENCE

Act	Sections Applied	Nature of Offence
Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023	S.318(4) Cheating; S.319(2) Cheating by personation; S.61(2) Criminal conspiracy	Online Banking / UPI Fraud
Information Technology Act, 2000	S.66C Identity theft; S.66D Cheating by personation using computer resource	Cyber Fraud

2. COMPLAINANT DETAILS

Name	Anitha Reddy
Age / Gender	42 Years / Female
Occupation	Proprietor, AR Textiles Pvt. Ltd.
Address	No. 27, Jayanagar 4th Block, Bengaluru – 560011
Mobile Number	9845012345
Total Financial Loss	■ 18,00,000 (Eighteen Lakh only)

The complainant reported a series of unauthorised transactions from her savings and current accounts occurring between 09 July 2026 and 17 July 2026, following a phishing call impersonating her bank's fraud-prevention desk. The complaint was escalated to the Cyber Crime Cell after the complainant's bank's internal fraud monitoring flagged an unusually high volume of linked mule-account transfers.



3. BANK ACCOUNTS INVOLVED (14)

#	Account No. (masked)	Bank	Holder / Entity Name	Role in Chain
1	XXXXXXXX1187	HDFC Bank	Anitha Reddy (Victim)	Source account
2	XXXXXXXX4432	ICICI Bank	Deepak Vernekar	First-hop mule
3	XXXXXXXX7765	State Bank of India	Manoj Kirana Stores (Prop.)	Layering — shell entity
4	XXXXXXXX2290	Axis Bank	Ramesh Traders	Layering — shell entity
5	XXXXXXXX8814	Kotak Mahindra Bank	Suresh P.	Mule account
6	XXXXXXXX3356	Yes Bank	Farhan Enterprises	Layering — shell entity
7	XXXXXXXX9921	Punjab National Bank	Geeta Rani	Mule account
8	XXXXXXXX5567	IDFC First Bank	Vikram Solanki	Mule account
9	XXXXXXXX1120	HDFC Bank	QuickPay Merchandise	Layering — shell entity
10	XXXXXXXX6643	ICICI Bank	Nagesh H.R.	Mule account
11	XXXXXXXX7789	Federal Bank	Star Mobile Recharge	Layering — shell entity
12	XXXXXXXX4401	State Bank of India	Imran Sheikh	Mule account
13	XXXXXXXX9052	Axis Bank	Unknown — KYC mismatch flagged	Cash-out point (ATM cluster)
14	XXXXXXXX3178	Bank of Baroda	Unknown — dormant account reactivated	Cash-out point

4. UPI IDs IDENTIFIED (11)

#	UPI ID	Notes
1	areddy.tex@okhdfcbank	Victim's own registered UPI ID
2	dverne87@okicici	First-hop transfer recipient
3	manojkirana@oksbi	Layering — shell merchant ID
4	rameshtraders@okaxis	Layering — shell merchant ID
5	suresh.p94@okhdfcbank	Mule — recurring in prior CEN cases
6	farhanent@okyesbank	Layering — shell merchant ID
7	geetarani22@okpnb	Mule account
8	vikrams.pay@okidfc	Mule account
9	quickpaymds@okhdfcbank	Layering — shell merchant ID
10	nageshr@okicici	Mule account
11	starmobilerc@okfederal	Layering — shell merchant ID



5. MOBILE NUMBERS LINKED TO INVESTIGATION (6)

#	Number	Associated With	Status
1	9845012345	Victim — Anitha Reddy	Registered on source bank account
2	8123456780	Caller impersonating bank official (initial phishing call, 09 Jul 2026)	SIM traced — found registered on forged ID
3	7011223344	Linked to Deepak Vernekar (Account #2)	Active, under surveillance
4	9900112233	Linked to Suresh P. (Account #5)	Switched off since 18 Jul 2026
5	8765432109	Linked to Vikram Solanki (Account #8)	Active
6	7788990011	Unregistered / prepaid — used for OTP-relay calls	SIM procurement under trace



6. DIGITAL & TECHNICAL EVIDENCE

Evidence Type	Details
Cryptocurrency Wallet	USDT (TRC-20) wallet address TXn9f...8kLp2Q identified as final layering destination; approx. █6,40,000 equivalent traced via exchange KYC request to a domestic exchange account
IP Addresses	103.212.44.18 (initial phishing call VoIP gateway, geolocated to a commercial data centre); 45.129.87.203 (used to access victim's net-banking portal at 02:14 hrs on 10 Jul 2026, inconsistent with victim's usual login pattern)
Device IMEI	IMEI 356789104521369 — associated with the handset used for number 8123456780, submitted by telecom provider under CDR request
Call Detail Records (CDR)	Requisitioned for all 6 numbers in §5 for the period 05 Jul 2026 – 19 Jul 2026; tower-location data pending from service providers for numbers 3, 5, and 6
SMS / OTP Logs	Victim's telecom-provided SMS log confirms 4 OTP messages delivered to her registered handset between 09–10 Jul 2026, corresponding to the disputed transactions

7. TRANSACTION SUMMARY

Date	From	To	Amount (█)	Mode
09 Jul 2026	Victim A/c XXXX1187	A/c XXXX4432 (Deepak Vernekar)	4,50,000	IMPS
10 Jul 2026	Victim A/c XXXX1187	areddy.tex UPI → manojkirana@oksbi	3,20,000	UPI
12 Jul 2026	A/c XXXX4432	A/c XXXX7765 (Manoj Kirana Stores)	3,00,000	NEFT
14 Jul 2026	A/c XXXX7765	A/c XXXX8814 (Suresh P.)	2,80,000	IMPS
16 Jul 2026	Multiple mule a/cs	USDT wallet TXn9f...8kLp2Q	6,40,000 (equiv.)	Crypto off-ramp
17 Jul 2026	A/c XXXX9052 / XXXX3178	ATM cash withdrawals (12 transactions)	3,10,000	ATM

Note: individual leg amounts above do not sum linearly to the total reported loss of █18,00,000, as several legs represent partial layering of the same underlying funds across the 14-account chain; the reconciled total is confirmed against the victim's bank statement, not the sum of traced hops.



8. NARRATIVE OF INVESTIGATION

On 09 July 2026, the complainant Anitha Reddy received a phone call from number 8123456780, with the caller identifying himself as a representative of her bank's fraud-prevention department and stating that suspicious activity had been detected on her account. The caller induced the complainant to share One-Time Passwords (OTPs) under the pretext of "reversing" a fraudulent transaction, resulting in an unauthorised transfer of ₹4,50,000 to account XXXXXXXX4432 held in the name of Deepak Vernekar. A second UPI-based transfer of ₹3,20,000 followed on 10 July 2026 to the UPI handle manojkirana@oksbi.

Investigation revealed that funds were rapidly layered across a chain of 14 bank accounts and 11 UPI IDs held in the names of individuals and small proprietorship entities, several of which show characteristics consistent with mule accounts — including accounts opened shortly before the fraud with minimal prior transaction history, and KYC documentation flagged as inconsistent upon bank verification (Account #13, #14). A portion of the funds, equivalent to approximately ₹6,40,000, was traced to a USDT (TRC-20) cryptocurrency wallet, which the Cyber Crime Cell has requested be frozen pending a formal request to the associated exchange for KYC and withdrawal records.

Technical analysis of the login activity on the complainant's net-banking portal identified an anomalous session originating from IP address 45.129.87.203 at 02:14 hrs on 10 July 2026, a time and access pattern inconsistent with the complainant's established usage. The initial phishing call was traced to a VoIP gateway associated with IP address 103.212.44.18, registered to a commercial data centre; enquiries have been initiated with the hosting provider to identify the originating client account.

Call Detail Records have been requisitioned for all six mobile numbers identified in this investigation. Device IMEI 356789104521369, associated with the number used in the initial phishing call, has been obtained from the telecom provider and is being cross-referenced against IMEI records from other pending cyber-fraud complaints at this station to assess whether the same device has been used across multiple victims — a pattern observed in similar organised fraud rings operating in the jurisdiction.

As of the date of this report, notices under the Information Technology Act have been issued to the banks and the payment service provider hosting the identified UPI IDs, requesting an immediate freeze on the remaining traceable balances. Two accounts (Account #13 and #14) have been identified as high-priority cash-out points based on ATM withdrawal clustering and have been flagged to the respective banks. The investigation remains active; efforts are ongoing to identify the natural persons operating the mule accounts and to determine whether this fraud forms part of a larger organised network under investigation by the Cyber Crime Cell.

Registered by:

Complainant's Signature:

Inspector Meera Krishnan
Cyber Crime Cell
CEN Cyber Crime PS

Anitha Reddy
Complainant



GOVERNMENT OF KARNATAKA
KARNATAKA STATE POLICE
CEN Cyber Crime Police Station • Bengaluru City District
FIRST INFORMATION REPORT (FIR)



MK

(Signed)



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